

THE LEAD-PACKAGE ECONOMY MODEL, v1.1

(RULED)

2026-08-31. Arithmetic model for Stephen's lead-package concept, against the canonical economy (Schedule B anchors, 2026-07-17 tuned drop tables, regen 150s, cap 100). It re-models the episode's requirement mass; it does not touch energy, regen, drop tables, CC sinks or SKUs.

v1.1: the four open numbers ruled by Stephen, 2026-08-31.

1. **Total mass: 1,600 T1eq**, tunable once the 100 story beats exist.
2. **The ramp envelope stands as a guide, with variety mandated:** never a mechanical progression. Late chapters keep quick single-card wins beside the five-carders; early chapters get the occasional spike; sizes and tiers mix within every chapter.
3. **CC holds the 4.3 earn rate: $\approx 6,880$ CC across the episode, banded per package.**
4. **No optional packages in Ep1: the 100 are everything.** No separate cold-case or teaser play. If an Ep2 teaser is wanted, it is a story beat inside the close package, not extra play; that is a structure question, not an economy one.

The concept, as ruled (Stephen, 2026-08-31)

- **A lead package is the unit of story progress.** Fulfilling a package shows the next story beat; individual card fulfilment no longer drives story.
- A package contains **1 to 5 lead cards**, drawing items from different characters and different item families.
- Difficulty ramps by package size and item tier: single low-tier cards early, five-card multi-family packages late.
- **Every package fulfilment pays off with something:** art with a caption, a previously unknown character fact, a line from Ally, or an evidence turn. Art and VO budgets are decided later and do not constrain this design.
- Tentative episode total: **about 100 packages**. About **10 chapters**; a chapter ends when Ally publishes.
- Constraints re-ruled the same day: 4 to 5 hours and 8 to 10 sessions are **guides, not hard constraints**; session boundary = publish beat is a **nice-to-have** where natural; "the gap is Brad listening" framing dropped; no-replay and ep01 slot ids stand.

Fixed anchors (not touched by this model)

Anchor	Value
Energy	1 per generator tap · regen 150s/point · free cap 100 · ladder 10/20/40/80 ingots · ads +20, 5/day
Drop tables	2026-07-17 spawn-low/merge-up curves; effective yield ≈ 1.55 T1eq per net energy (Schedule B measured: 330 T1eq from ≈ 213 net energy, ≈ 233 taps)
Session tank	≈ 100 free energy per well-spaced session (cap refill dominates daily income; the July structural finding)
CC earn yardstick	≈ 4.3 CC per T1eq

Anchor	Value
Card quantity cap	LeadRequirement.quantity is [Range(1, 3)]: no card asks for more than 3 of an item

The headline arithmetic (at the ruled 1,600 T1eq)

- **100 packages** $\approx$ a story beat every **2.5 to 3 minutes** of play. Genre-correct cadence.
- **250 cards** at the working ramp (average 2.5 cards per package); average **6.4 T1eq per card**: mostly single T2 to T4 items in small quantities, no board-straining walls, quantity cap 3 respected.
- **Requirement mass 1,600 T1eq** (4.8x Schedule B's 330).
- **Net energy** $\approx$ **1,030** ($1,600 \div 1.55$) $\approx$ **10.3 free session-tanks**: the episode genuinely occupies about ten sittings without tank surgery, ladder spend, or ads; the ladder and ads shorten it for players who choose to.
- **Days to complete**: ~ 10 at one session a day, ~ 5 to 6 at two. **This resolves the July finding**: Schedule B's ~ 2 -day episode needed $\sim 700+$ T1eq to reach genre-typical length, and the package model carries 1,600 comfortably because the mass is spread across 250 small cards instead of 12 walls.
- **CC: $\approx 6,880$ across the episode at the ruled 4.3 rate** (was 1,410), banded per package. Sinks are absolute-priced (locker, Mo's, Case Kit), so this expands sink headroom; deeper locker slots and shop buys come into Ep1 reach, which the doubling curves were built for.

The ramp (guide, 10 packages per chapter, variety mandated)

Ch	Packages	Avg cards/pkg	Cards	T1eq budget	Net energy	Feel
1	10	1.0	10	35	≈ 23	FTUE. Single cards, T1 to T2, instant wins; the cold open vo.4 spread across the first packages
2	10	1.5	15	70	≈ 45	Second family unlocks; one spike package
3	10	2.0	20	105	≈ 68	First two-card, two-family packages
4	10	2.0	20	135	≈ 87	Tier climb begins
5	10	2.5	25	170	≈ 110	Mid-episode; Mo's and locker doing work
6	10	2.5	25	205	≈ 132	
7	10	3.0	30	215	≈ 139	Three-family packages standard
8	10	3.0	30	220	≈ 142	First five-card package
9	10	3.5	35	220	≈ 142	
10	10	4.0	40	225	≈ 145	Finale; five-card multi-family peaks, with quick wins kept beside them
Total	100	2.5	250	1,600	$\approx 1,032$	

The averages are an envelope, not a pattern (ruled). Every chapter mixes sizes and tiers: a one-card quickie sits beside a four-carder in chapter 9, and chapter 2 carries one deliberate spike. Monotonic size-by-size progression is exactly what Stephen rejected. Per-chapter play at ~ 1.1 taps per net energy point lands each chapter at roughly one sitting (chapter 1 lighter by design).

What this supersedes and what it does not

- **Supersedes:** Schedule B's 330 T1eq / 12-lead requirement plan as the production-episode model, and the 16-lead structure premise of `episode-1-lead-structure-four-keys-v1.0.md` (rework to v2.0 as chapters × packages; its 16 leads survive as the turn-beat skeleton and its Part F questions stand).
- **Does not touch:** the slice as shipped, drop tables, energy system, CC sinks, SKUs, FTUE grants.

Open tuning items (drafted here, ruled later)

1. Per-package card-size and tier mix inside each chapter (the envelope above; variety per the ruling).
2. CC reward bands per package against the ≈6,880 total; whether energy/ingot rewards scale with it.
3. Chapter 1's exact FTUE budget in seconds and packages (waits on the I6 first-interaction ruling and the v0.4 cut).
4. Beat payoff type per package (art+caption / character fact / Ally line / evidence turn): drafted in the structure rework, budgeted later per Stephen's ruling.
5. The whole mass re-tuned once the 100 story beats exist, per the ruling on question 1.

The systems bill, named and not costed here

A package container above lead cards: data (PackageData or an extension of the existing lead/requirement shape), leads-bar UI grouping, package-complete beat presentation (art+caption surface), gating by package rather than card, save schema addition, FTUE teaching, analytics events. Sits on top of `feature/multi-episode-audit`, which is still unmerged and not play-verified. Cost it the way the multi-episode bill was costed, before build.